

Build & Grow AI Hackathon : Official Guide

The **Build & Grow AI Hackathon** is a premier developer event, organised by **GDG Cloud Pune, AI Pune** in collaboration with **GDG Cloud Mumbai**. This initiative is designed for students, professionals and emerging developers to master the full AI development lifecycle using **Google's cutting-edge AI technologies**.

1. Hackathon Phases and Timeline

The journey, referred to as the "Build & Grow Express", is structured into distinct phases leading from initial learning to the final presentation.

- **Registration & Team Onboarding (Started from 1 January 2026):** Participants begin forming teams and registering for the event.
 - **Team Selection Phase (21-Jan-2026):** This will be done by the Organising team and the Organising team will send an email to the selected team.
 - **Phase 1: Pre-Hackathon (24–25 January 2026):**
 - A **24-hour in-person coding marathon** focused on rapid prototyping.
 - **Locations:** This phase is held locally at the **Pune Hub** (Data Axle, ICC Tech Tower) and **Mumbai Hub** (NMIMS Mukesh Patel).
 - Participation is on a **first-come, first-served basis** due to venue seat availability.
 - **Phase 2: Grand Finale (26 January 2026):**
 - Only teams selected in the Pre-Hackathon will be eligible to participate in this round.
 - The culmination of the event will take place exclusively in Mumbai. **Selected teams must arrange their own travel and commute for the finale.**
 - **Shortlisting:** Only the **Top 20 Teams** from the Pre-Hackathon will be selected to travel to Mumbai to present their solutions to a panel of judges.
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2. Themes and Problem Statements

Participants are encouraged to build real-time solutions with impactful, agentic AI use cases across several key domains:

- **HealthTech:** Smarter diagnostics, patient monitoring, and intelligent healthcare workflows.
- **AgriTech:** Data-driven, scalable solutions for modern agriculture.
- **FinTech:** Financial automation, risk analysis, and real-time fraud prevention.
- **Cyber Security:** Intelligent threat detection and prevention systems.
- **EduTech:** Personalized learning and skill-building platforms at scale
- **Open Category:** If a solution does not fit the specific domains, participants can propose an **Open Problem** to build any impactful AI-driven solution.

3. Rules and Participation Requirements

To ensure a fair and productive environment, the following rules apply:

- **Team Composition:** Participants may compete individually or in **teams of up to 3 members**.
- **Compulsory Equipment:** This is a coding-intensive event. **Laptops are mandatory** and must be brought fully charged; participants without one will not be admitted.
- **Punctuality:** The event begins promptly at **10:00 AM**. Late arrivals may lose their eligibility for team formation or participation.
- **Identification:** Professionals must carry a **Government ID**, while students must provide a **College ID** for verification at the registration desk.
- **Cost:** Registration is **Free of Charge**, but mandatory.
- **Location:** Participants must follow all the restrictions and guidelines provided for the venue. Any inconvenience can cause termination of the team.
- **Food:** Food would be provided by us and none of the outside items will be allowed inside the venue.
- **Medical Assistance:** Participants with medical conditions are advised to keep their prescribed medications with them at all times.
- **Internet and Wifi:** Internet access will be available for participants.

4. Corporate Venue Instructions (Mandatory Compliance)

- As the hackathon is hosted at corporate office premises, all participants must strictly follow the below guidelines:
- Alcohol, tobacco, smoking, and vaping are strictly prohibited within the venue premises
- The venue is a No-Smoking Zone at all times
- Participants will not be allowed to leave the venue during night hours without prior permission
- If a participant exits the venue at night:
- Entry and exit will be logged by security personnel
- The participant must inform venue security in advance
- Failure to inform security or violation of exit protocols will make the participant solely responsible for any consequences

- Any misconduct or breach of corporate discipline may lead to immediate removal from the event

5. Registration Process

Participant registration will commence at 8:30 AM, followed by the event starting at 10:00 AM. The registration system is streamlined to prevent duplicate entries:

- **Team Lead Responsibility:** The registration form must be completed by the **Team Lead ONLY**.
 - **Ticketing:** Wristbands will be provided to each team member. Entry to the event will not be permitted without a wristband. The organizers will not be responsible for any consequences arising from damaged or lost wristbands.
 - **Teammate Details:** The Team Lead must provide the names of their teammates within the form. Individual participants should leave these fields blank.
 - **Approval:** Registration is subject to **host approval**.
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6. Benefits and Takeaways

Beyond the competition, the hackathon serves as a hub for talent and growth:

- **Expert Mentorship:** Projects are evaluated by professionals at the forefront of the AI revolution.
 - **Networking:** Opportunities to connect with startup founders, tech leaders, and senior engineers.
 - **Recognition:** Winners compete for an **exciting pool of prizes**, and standout projects may be featured across social media platforms for massive community exposure.
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Enjoy the event! All the Best!